

Landlord Compliance Checklist — Northern Territory

The obligations every rental provider must meet under the Residential Tenancies Act 1999.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only, not legal advice. Confirm current requirements with Northern Territory Consumer Affairs before relying on this checklist alone.

Section 1 — Bonds

- ☐ [] **Respect the maximum bond of 4 weeks' rent.**
- ☐ [] **Hold bond funds in a designated trust account** if you're an agent, or in trust if you're a private landlord — tenants are entitled to know the bank and account details.
- ☐ [] **Provide a receipt** for bond paid by cheque, cash, or credit card.
- ☐ [] **Notify the relevant authority if you'll be away from the NT for more than 14 days** as a private landlord.
- ☐ [] **Never claim fair wear and tear against a bond.**

Section 2 — Rent

- ☐ [] **Only increase rent if all required conditions are met:** your agreement has a rent-increase clause, the calculation method is documented, you give at least **30 days' notice**, the increase doesn't occur in the first **6 months**, and it happens no more than **once every 6 months**.
- ☐ [] **Never engage in rent bidding, rent auctions, or gazumping** — these are specifically prohibited, along with unilaterally increasing rent between offer and formal agreement.
- ☐ [] **Follow the correct arrears process:** a 7-day notice once rent is more than 14 days overdue, with an NTCAT application available if the tenant doesn't pay within that window.

Section 3 — Applications and Privacy

- ☐ [] **Only gather the most relevant personal information needed to assess an application** — don't over-collect.
- ☐ [] **Take reasonable steps to protect tenant information**, and destroy it within required timeframes.
- ☐ [] **Understand tenancy database listing rules** — there are specific circumstances governing when someone can be listed, with a pathway for a victim tenant to apply to NTCAT to have their information removed.

Section 4 — Condition Reports and Repairs

- ☐ [] **Complete entry and exit condition reports** for every tenancy.
- ☐ [] **Respond to repair requests promptly**, particularly cyclone/storm-damage-related issues given the NT's climate.
- ☐ [] **Keep thorough records** — photos, correspondence, receipts, and condition reports.

Section 5 — The NT's Tax Advantage (Relevant to Your Overall Compliance Picture)

- ☐ [] **Remember there's no land tax to manage** — a genuinely lighter ongoing compliance and cost burden compared to every other Australian jurisdiction, worth factoring into your overall investment property management approach.
- ☐ [] **Focus your compliance energy on tenancy law and safety obligations**, since the tax-side administrative burden is comparatively minimal in the NT.

Quick Reference — NT Landlord Compliance Calendar

Obligation	Detail
Maximum bond	4 weeks' rent
Rent increase conditions	Clause required, 30 days' notice, none in first 6 months, max once per 6 months
Rent bidding/gazumping	Prohibited
Rent arrears process	14 days overdue → 7-day notice → NTCAT application
Land tax	None

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